



"FOSTERING A CULTURE OF invention can help create products that make sense in India."

**ASWIN CHANDRASEKARAN ,
INVENTION LABS, 27**

Aswin Chandrasekaran studied engineering but ended up innovating something which a medical researcher is expected to do. The University of Texas alumnus made a hand-held communications aid for cerebral palsy patients. The device has a rich graphical interface, a processor capable of running a Linux operating system, and an USB-based non-contact switch that can be easily controlled by children with poor motor skills. Called Kavi, it costs one tenth of the comparable devices abroad. Chandrasekaran seeks to give Indian engineering an identity in the global map and to achieve this he set up Invention Labs along with Ajit Narayanan, 27, Adib Ibrahim, 28, and Preetham K. Shivanna, 26—all from IT Madras. Apart from Kavi, they have developed other products like machine vision systems for quality control and retail vending machines. The company currently has 11 employees and to ensure cash flow they also design sub-components and products for various industries.

by Mahalingam Ponnusamy

Role Model

Bill Gates because he built a successful business by taking his product to every corner of the world.



HK RAJASHEKAR

"A SUCCESSFUL BUSINESS IS the direct result of intelligence and courageous decisions."

M.THIAGARAJAN, PARAMOUNT AIRWAYS, 31



HK RAJASHEKAR

Passionate About

Astronavigation. Thiagarajan can tell you the location of a place by just seeing a star.

While on a holiday in Frankfurt, Germany, at the age of 21, he got an opportunity to control the world's most famous aircraft, the 747 Jumbo Jet. This ignited his passion for the flying machine and he enrolled in a flying school near London in 1994. He wanted to expand his joy to his countrymen. So the third generation textile entrepreneur and MD of Paramount Mills, M. Thiagarajan, ventured into the aviation sector to launch his Chennai-based Paramount Airways in 2005. His business model was unique with his airlines catering only to the business-class. Besides, Paramount became the first domestic carrier to introduce the New Generation Embraer 170/190 family series aircraft equipped with unique Category II low visibility auto-land. With a market leadership of 26 per cent in south India, the airways now operates to 12 destinations. While expanding his flight network in the western part of the country, the management graduate from Thiagaraja College, Madurai, plans to set up a new hub in Kolkata soon. After completing the mandatory five years in the domestic circle, Paramount will launch international services by 2012. Apart from his love for aircraft, Thiagarajan loves the Maldives and likes to shop in Indonesia. He is a great gadget freak as well. His enthusiasm for flying extends to yachting, golfing and adventure sports.

by Adhi Vallappan